FIGHTERBASE

Paleo

Diet guide

Meat, fish, eggs, veg, fruit, nuts. No grains, legumes or dairy.



Prepared 10 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Paleo**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Paleo?

Based on foods available before farming: meat, fish, eggs, veg, fruit, nuts and seeds. Grains, legumes, dairy and processed food are left out.

Where it comes from

Popularised in the 2000s (Loren Cordain and others) on the idea of eating like pre-agricultural humans. The rule of thumb: if a hunter-gatherer could have hunted or gathered it, it is in. Grains, legumes, dairy and processed foods are out.

The main ideas

1. Eat meat, fish, eggs, vegetables, fruit, nuts and seeds.
2. Avoid grains, legumes (beans, lentils, peanuts), dairy, refined sugar and processed food.
3. Choose the best quality you can afford: grass-fed, wild-caught, seasonal.
4. Cook from scratch.
5. Potatoes are often debated; many versions allow sweet potato and some allow white potato.

Who it suits

- People who like clear rules and whole foods
- People who feel better off bread and dairy
- People who want to cook more and eat less processed food

> **Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:**
>
> - You have a medical condition or allergy
> - You are pregnant or breastfeeding
> - You are under 18
> - You have ever had an eating disorder
> - You are cutting weight for a fight

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Paleo can be low in carbs by accident. Add sweet potato, squash, fruit, plantain and honey around hard training.
- Eat enough: without bread, rice and pasta, calories drop quickly.
- Calcium: dairy is out, so lean on sardines with bones, leafy greens, almonds, and ask a professional about supplements.
- Eggs, meat and fish make hitting protein targets easy.

> Sweet potatoes, potatoes (for some), fruit and plantain cover carbs around training. Protein is easy.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Calcium and vitamin D
bones, especially in impact sport
Where: sardines, tinned salmon with bones, kale, almonds, sunlight, a supplement

Carbohydrate
fuels hard sessions
Where: sweet potato, banana, squash, fruit, honey

Fibre
gut health
Where: vegetables, fruit, nuts, seeds

Iodine
thyroid and metabolism
Where: seafood, seaweed, iodised salt

Common mistakes

- Eating too few carbs for training volume
- Treating 'paleo-friendly' baked goods as unlimited
- Ignoring calcium
- Avoiding all carbs, including fruit and starchy vegetables
- Eating lots of bacon and processed paleo snacks

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Hidden grains and sugars: maltodextrin, wheat starch, soy lecithin, glucose syrup
- Dairy hides as: whey, casein, lactose, milk solids
- Check sausages, stock cubes and spice mixes for fillers

Eating out

- Grilled meat or fish with vegetables or salad.
- Ask for olive oil and lemon instead of dressing.
- Skip bread, rice, pasta and cheese.
- Sweet potato fries are a common safe swap.

Easy swaps

Bread	→	Lettuce wrap or sweet potato slice
Rice	→	Cauliflower rice or roast sweet potato
Milk	→	Coconut milk or almond milk (no additives)
Pasta	→	Courgetti
Sugar	→	Raw honey or maple syrup, sparingly

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Eggs, avocado, fruit	Chicken, sweet potato, salad	Salmon, roast vegetables
Tue	Banana and almond butter, boiled eggs	Tuna salad with olive oil	Beef stir-fry with vegetables
Wed	Omelette with peppers	Leftover stir-fry	Roast chicken, carrots, parsnips
Thu	Sausages (check ingredients), eggs, tomatoes	Prawn salad	Pork chops, squash, greens
Fri	Fruit and nuts, boiled eggs	Turkey, avocado, lettuce wraps	Steak, sweet potato wedges, broccoli
Sat	Sweet potato hash with eggs	Soup (vegetable and meat)	Lamb, roast vegetables
Sun	Bacon, eggs, fruit	Leftover roast and salad	Fish, plantain, vegetables

Snacks

Fruit · Nuts and seeds · Boiled eggs · Jerky (no sugar) · Vegetable sticks and guacamole · Coconut chips · Olives

Shopping list

Meat, fish, eggs · Vegetables and fruit · Sweet potato, squash · Nuts and seeds · Olive oil, coconut oil, avocado oil · Herbs and spices · Honey, maple syrup (small amounts)

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Are potatoes paleo?

It depends on the version. Sweet potato is almost always allowed; white potato is debated.

Is cheese paleo?

Strict paleo says no. Some people keep fermented or grass-fed dairy (that is called Primal).

Is it good for athletes?

It can be, if you add enough starchy carbs and calcium. Both are easy to miss.

Further reading

British Dietetic Association; reviews of paleolithic diets in the American Journal of Clinical Nutrition and similar.



For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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